Paul L. Tran
(he/him/his)

Curriculum Vitae (CV)
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Current Positions

2026–	**Economist** (Incoming)	US Department of the Treasury

Previous Positions

- Please see the "Teaching history" section for details about my teaching employment and experience.

2018–2020	**Senior Research Assistant**	Board of Governors of the Federal Reserve System
2017–2018	**Research Assistant**	Board of Governors of the Federal Reserve System

Education

2026	**PhD**	Economics	University of Texas at Austin

- Dissertation: "Essays on Applications of Text Analysis in Macroeconomics"
- Committee: Olivier Coibion (Co-Supervisor), Christoph E. Boehm (Co-Supervisor), Saroj Bhattarai, Amy Handlan

2023	**MS en Passant**	Economics	University of Texas at Austin
2017	**BA**	Mathematics, Mathematical Economics	Pomona College

Research Interests

- **Fields**: Macroeconomics, Monetary Economics
- **Methods**: Text Analysis, Machine Learning

Working papers

1. Tran, Paul L. (2026). "How Long Do Markets Need to Fully React to Monetary Policy Announcements?" **Job Market Paper**. URL: https://paulletran.com/papers/wps/tran_paul_le_fomc_nn_paper_jmp.pdf.
   Abstract: This paper shows that financial markets need more time than the standard 30 minutes to fully react to monetary policy announcements. I systematically estimate these optimal window lengths using a neural network text analysis method. I find that the required time increases with asset underlying maturity (reaching 50–60 minutes for maturities at least two quarters ahead) and FOMC statement characteristics: complexity, novelty, and dissents. This timing difference has economic consequences: optimal windows correct for the attenuated impact of monetary policy shocks about forward guidance on interest rates, break-even inflation, and equity prices, and yield more precise macroeconomic responses.
2. Tran, Paul L. (2026). "Does the Narrative See-Saw of Monetary Policy Announcements Affect Market Expectations?" URL: https://paulletran.com/papers/wps/tran_paul_le_fomc_topicshares_paper_wp.pdf.
   Abstract: This paper shows that the thematic composition of FOMC statements affects market expectations of future monetary policy. I quantify changes in communication bandwidth across topics using large-language-model probabilistic topic classification. Using an event-study approach, I document a "narrative see-saw" effect: a relative expansion of monetary policy tool discussions, which compresses macroeconomic context, amplifies the variation of monetary policy surprises. These signals remain significant after controlling for policy actions and semantic novelty. Including both textual measures improves explanatory power by 30% relative to the policy action alone. Thus, markets respond to the simultaneous trade-off between policy discussion and macroeconomic context.
3. Tran, Paul L. (2026). "Deciphering Financial Market Reactions to OPEC Announcements: A Neural Network Approach". SSRN Working Paper No 4968664. DOI: 10.2139/ssrn.4968664.
   Abstract: This paper shows that OPEC communications affect oil supply expectations, oil prices, and the macroeconomy beyond the effects of setting production limits and changing current production. Using

neural network methods for text analysis, I create a new oil supply expectations "text shock" from OPEC statements that is derived from variation in oil futures prices purified of noise, demand information, and endogenous responses to global economic activity. The "purified surprises" correlate with 74% of the observed supply surprises. Impulse responses from vector autoregressions using my shock do not exhibit output puzzles and are more consistent with theory than those previously reported.

Presentations

2026	US Department of the Treasury (Washington, DC), Texas State University (San Marcos, TX), Loyola University Chicago (Chicago, IL), Spring Midwest Macroeconomics Meeting (Milwaukee, WI), North American Summer Meetings of Econometric Society (Emory University, GA), European Economic Association Meeting (Scheduled, University College Dublin, Ireland)
2025	Texas Macro Job Candidate Conference (College Station, TX), IMIM Rising Stars Seminar Series (Virtual)

Teaching History

- Since Fall 2024, student evaluations have rated my teaching 4.6 out of 5 on average.
- Since Fall 2020, student evaluations have rated my teaching assistance 4.4 out of 5 on average.
- I earned an Advanced Teaching Preparation Certificate in 2023 from the University of Texas at Austin.

University of Texas at Austin	**Assistant Instructor**	Fall 2024–2025	Introduction to Macroeconomics
	Teaching Assistant	Spring 2026	Time Series Econometrics, Sahil Ravgotra
		Spring 2024	Macro and the Labor Market (MA course), Andreas Mueller
			Labor Economics (MA course), Gerald Oettinger
		Fall 2021–2023	Introduction to Microeconomics (Synchronous Massive Online Course for fall), Charity-Joy Acchiardo, Wayne Geerling, Dirk Mateer
		Summer 2022	Health Economics, Helen Schneider
		Fall 2020, Spring 2021	Introduction to Macroeconomics, Michael Sadler, Charity-Joy Acchiardo

Honours and Awards

2020–2026	**Graduate Teaching Fellowship**	University of Texas at Austin	
2026	**Professional Development Award**	University of Texas at Austin	\$500
2025	**PhD Summer Research Fellowship**	University of Texas at Austin	\$5,000
2025	**Empirical Macro Economics Policy Center of Texas Dissertation Funding**	University of Texas at Austin	\$1,919
2024	**PhD Summer Research Fellowship**	University of Texas at Austin	\$5,000
2023	**PhD Summer Research Fellowship**	University of Texas at Austin	\$3,000
2017	**Distinction in Economics Senior Exercise**	Pomona College	
2016	**Harry G. Steele Scholarship**	Pomona College	\$4,000
2014–2015	**Pomona College Scholar**	Pomona College	
2013	**Flextronics Texas Scholarship**	Pomona College	\$1,000

Service

External https://paulletran.com/econ-grad-app-deadlines/ Creator and Maintainer (2019–)

Miscellaneous Information

- **Programming:** Matlab, Python, Bash, SAS, FAME, (P)SQL, R, Stata, EViews, LaTeX
- **Front-end Development:** Vanilla HTML, CSS, JS, Jekyll
- **Applications:** Visual Studio Code, Emacs, Git, Sublime Text, RStudio, Tableau, Microsoft Office
- **Operating Systems:** Unix, Linux, Windows
- **Languages:** English (native), Vietnamese (native)